MICHELLE STERMITZ

Frontend Engineer · Design Systems · UX Engineering
(310) 740-4913 · stermitzm@gmail.com · michellestermitz.com · LinkedIn · GitHub

PROFILE

Frontend engineer with five years of experience specializing in design systems, component architecture, accessibility, and UX-focused frontend development across ecommerce, mobile, and data-driven applications. I work best at the intersection of engineering and design – bringing aesthetic judgment and architectural thinking to products that are polished, accessible, and maintainable.

SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML, CSS
Frontend: React, Vue, Next.js, React Native, Storybook, Tailwind, Nuxt, Styled Components, Bootstrap, Material UI, GraphQL, Three.js, Framer Motion
Backend: Node.js, Firebase, PostgreSQL, Prisma
Tools and Services: Git, Figma, Vercel, Netlify, Postman, Datadog, CommerceTools, Algolia, Lucidchart, Cursor

EXPERIENCE

Frontend Software Engineer
Jan 2024 - Aug 2025
Powell's Books - Portland, OR

- Joined mid-migration on a major e-commerce rebuild, owning full-stack feature delivery and navigating complex integrations across CommerceTools, Algolia, Vue/Nuxt, and multiple third-party services.
- Identified and shipped missing core commerce functionality including checkout flow and billing address ahead of the site's public release; drove ongoing stability and quality improvements across the codebase.
- Led Storybook adoption for the Vue codebase, refactoring legacy components into a reusable design system and rebuilding the product detail page, search results, and checkout pages.
- Championed accessibility site-wide, working through a large audit backlog and delivering hands-on improvements across the product.

Fullstack Software Engineer
May 2021 - March 2023
Olio Apps - Portland, OR

- Independently developed the frontend for two React Native mobile apps, including a barometric pressure tracker for *EarPlanes* product line.
- Led a three-person team to develop a solar panel installation quote app - architected frontend features, contributed to cloud functions, and owned testing and reliability of the quote calculator.
- Contributed significantly to the frontend of a decarbonization platform, building responsive dashboard components and intricate forms for entering detailed building specifications.
- Specialized in atomic design and trained team members in Storybook-driven development for scalable, consistent UI components.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS
December 2020 – Present

michellestermitz.com
Portfolio site built with Next.js, React, Three.js, and React Fiber - includes custom 3D animations and responsive design.

Thought Catalogue - Desktop App (in progress)
Desktop app built with Tauri, Rust, and React. Combines file system management with Markdown note-writing. Emphasis on minimal, focused UX.

terminal-tarot — NPM Package
Published CLI tarot reader as an npm package with organic user installs.

OpenAI Interviewer
AI-powered mock interview application that generates role-specific technical questions, captures interview notes, and provides response feedback.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Graphic Designer, Marketing Assistant
Jan 2017 - Dec 2019
Freelance

- Brand-aligned design, content editing, keyword mapping, and SEO work for multiple small business clients.

Graphic Designer, Manager
Jan 2013 - Dec 2017
The Stensrud Playhouse - Missoula, MT

- Designed all print and digital marketing materials for an independent theater; developed social media presence, WordPress website, and MailChimp newsletter.
- Managed box office, kitchen operations, and staff.
- Delivered marketing results including 25+ sold-out shows.

EDUCATION

Alchemy Code Lab
Dec 2020
Fullstack JavaScript Certificate - Portland, OR
800+ hour full stack software development program. JavaScript, HTML, CSS, React, and PostgreSQL with an emphasis on test-driven development and collaboration.

Santa Monica College
Anthropology - Santa Monica, CA

University of Canterbury
Anthropology - Christchurch, NZ